GITHUB COPILOT DEV DAYS | CHENNAI

Hands-on with GitHub Copilot Agents & Workflows: Plan, Build, Review, Ship



17-Oct-2026 (Saturday) · 10:45 – 13:30 IST · Works on Copilot Free
Venue: AstraZeneca

Workshop repo
https://github.com/NaveenPrabhuC/copilot-dev-days-workshop



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MODERATORS

Here to help you today



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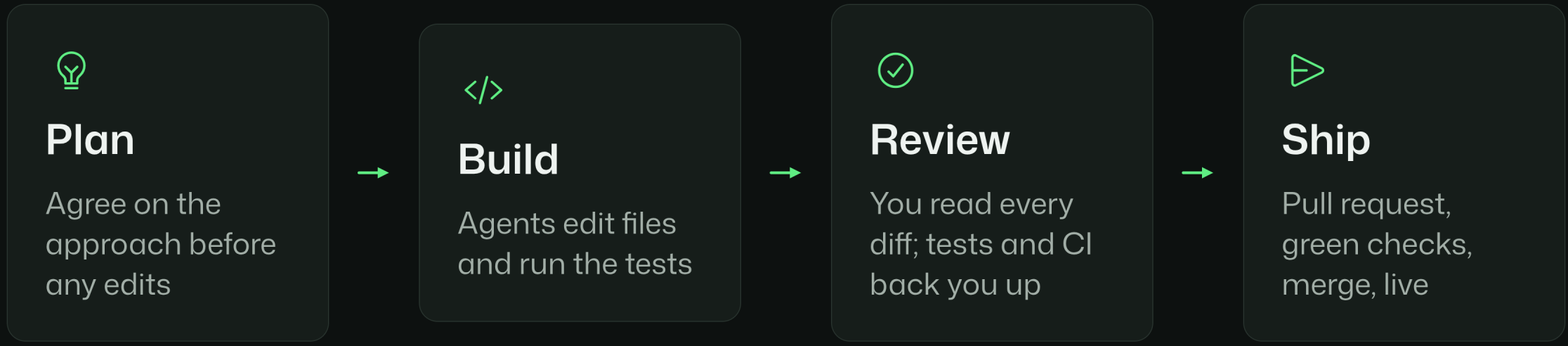
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TODAY'S GOAL

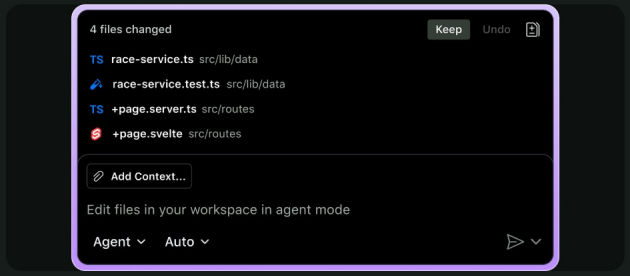
You direct the work. Agents do the building.



Same loop in VS Code, the CLI and the app. Today we practise it in VS Code.

ONE COPILOT, THREE WAYS TO WORK

Today in VS Code. The rest at your own pace.



TODAY · GUIDED

VS Code

Step by step, together in the hall

`workshops/vscode.md`

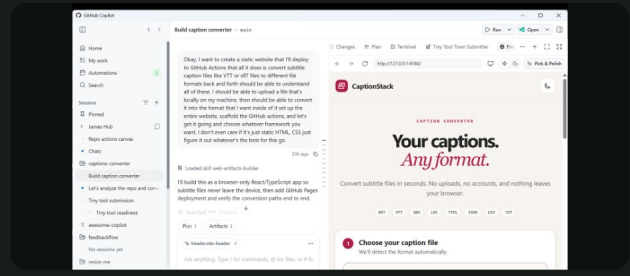


AT HOME · SELF-PACED

Copilot CLI

Same features, in your terminal

`workshops/cli.md`



AT HOME · SELF-PACED

Copilot app

Same features, in the desktop app

`workshops/copilot-app.md`

AGENDA · IST

Ten chapters, one morning

10:45	0 · Setup check
10:50	1 · Warm-up
11:05	2 · Instructions
11:20	Break
11:50	3 · Plan → build
12:10	4 · Debug
12:20	5 · Refactor
12:30	6 · CI with GitHub Actions
12:40	7 · Agent skills
12:50	8 · Backlog of issues
13:00	9 · Issue → PR → merge
13:25	10 · Ship & retro
13:30	Done · bonus chapters

CHAPTERS ARE INDEPENDENT · BEHIND? TAKE THE SHORTCUT AND KEEP GOING

WHAT EVERYONE BUILDS

One small quiz app, seven real upgrades



Dev Days Quiz

Plain HTML, CSS and JavaScript. No dependencies.

01 Feedback message
02 Project instructions
03 Countdown timer
04 A fixed bug + tests
05 Cleaner, pure logic
06 CI and a reusable skill
07 Best score, via a PR
→ Live on GitHub Pages

SAME STARTER CODE AND FEATURES IN THE VS CODE, CLI AND APP GUIDES

THE STARTER REPO

Your first test run should not be green

```
copilot-dev-days-workshop/
├─ workshops/ vscode · cli · copilot-app
├─ src/
│ ├─ quiz.js pure logic
│ ├─ app.js DOM + events
│ └─ questions.js quiz data
├─ tests/ node:test
└─ package.json no dependencies
```

```
$ npm test
```

8 pass
1 fail

One bug is planted on purpose. Leave it until Chapter 4.

USE THIS TEMPLATE → YOUR OWN PUBLIC REPO → CHAPTER 0

COPILOT FREE BUDGET

The whole morning fits in your free credits

~50
chat and agent requests per month on Copilot Free

~16
used by the ten core chapters, in any room

25+
left this month before you start

One prompt = one request. Run npm test and git yourself: they're free.

LIMITS CAN CHANGE · CHECK GITHUB.COM/SETTINGS/COPILOT

RULES OF THE ROOM

Five habits that get you to 13:30

01	**Time-boxes are real**	5 minutes over? Take the shortcut, move on
02	**Chapters are independent**	Skipping one never blocks a later one
03	**One prompt, done well**	Copy prompts as written; finish 90% by hand
04	**Review before you keep**	Read every diff. You own the code
05	**Commit at every checkpoint**	Small commits make undo free

YOUR OUTPUT WILL DIFFER FROM YOUR NEIGHBOUR'S · COMPARE THE "DONE WHEN" CHECKS

PART 1 · 10:50 – 11:20

Foundations

Chapter 1 · Warm-up
Chapter 2 · Instructions



CHAPTER 1 · 10:50 – 11:05 · 0 REQUESTS

Warm-up: completions in VS Code

COMPLETIONS

Comment → code

Describe the function in a comment, then press Tab.

NEXT EDIT SUGGESTIONS

Rename once

Copilot predicts the other edits. Tab through them.

GENERATED DATA

Then verify

Tests check the shape. You check the facts.

Done when the results screen shows a feedback message, you have 9+ questions, and only the planted test fails.

CHAPTER 2 · 11:05 – 11:20 · 1 REQUEST

Instructions: teach your rules once

REPO-WIDE · /init

.github/copilot-instructions.md or AGENTS.md

Sent with every request. Trim it: every line costs context.

PATH-SPECIFIC · BY HAND

.github/instructions/tests.instructions.md

Only applies when Copilot touches matching files.

```
---
applyTo: "tests/**/*.js"
---
- Use only node:test and
node:assert/strict.
- One behaviour per test.
- Cover boundaries, empty
input and null.
```

TIP: /INIT NEEDS A PROMPT AFTER IT · THEN CHECK THE CONTEXT VIEW

11:20 - 11:50

Break

Back at 11:50. Behind? Catch up to the end of Chapter 2.



PART 2 · 11:50 – 12:30

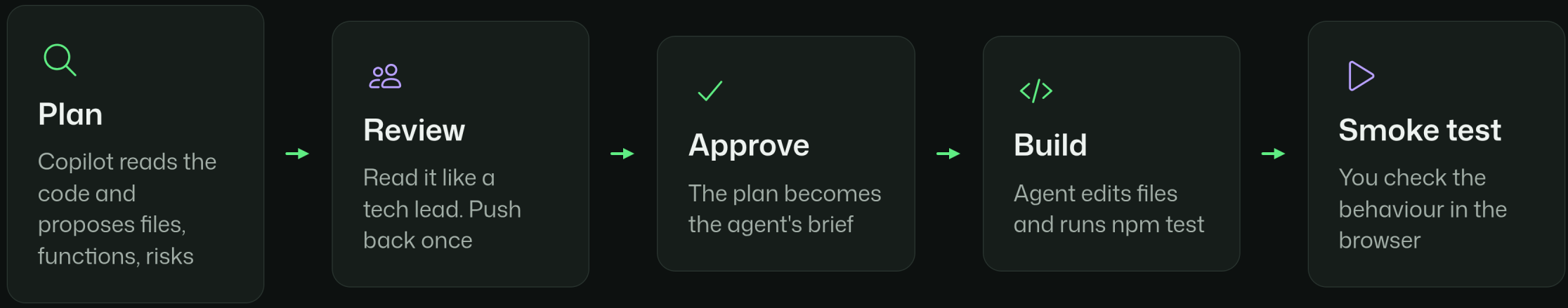
Plan, build, verify



Chapter 3 · Plan → build
Chapter 4 · Debug
Chapter 5 · Refactor

CHAPTER 3 · 11:50 – 12:10 · 2–3 REQUESTS

Plan mode: fix the approach before the first edit



THE QUESTION TO ASK OF THE PLAN

Is the timer cleared on answer, timeout, next *and* restart?

BROKEN AT 12:10? UNDO AND MOVE ON · LATER CHAPTERS DON'T NEED THE TIMER

CHAPTER 4 · 12:10 – 12:20 · 1 REQUEST

Debug: let the agent run red → green

Run the tests

npm test shows the one planted failure

Root cause

Ask why, and where else the mistake hides

Fix + tests

Fix it and add boundary tests

Green

Re-run until every test passes

Ask for the root cause and related code, not just "fix this".

BEHIND? THE GUIDE'S SHORTCUT IS A ONE-LINE MANUAL FIX · ZERO REQUESTS

CHAPTER 5 · 12:20 – 12:30 · 1 REQUEST

Refactor with a safety net

BEFORE · APP.JS

State, rules and DOM all mixed together



AFTER · QUIZ.JS

```
createQuiz(questions)
answerQuestion(state, i)
isQuizFinished(state)
```

✓ Tests stay green

✓ No input is mutated

✓ Behaviour unchanged

COMMIT FIRST · IF IT BREAKS AND YOU CAN'T FIX IT IN 2 MINUTES: GIT RESTORE .

PART 3 · 12:30 – 13:30

Automate and ship



Chapter 6 · CI · Chapter 7 · Agent skills
Chapters 8–9 · Issue → PR → merge · Chapter 10 · Ship

CHAPTER 6 · 12:30 – 12:40 · 1 REQUEST

CI: GitHub runs your tests on every PR

```
.github/workflows/test.yml
name: Tests
on: push (main), pull_request
jobs: test · ubuntu-latest
- actions/checkout@v4
- actions/setup-node@v4 (Node 20)
- run: npm test
```

1 Agent writes the workflow

2 You push it

3 Actions tab goes green

4 Badge on your README

PUSH REJECTED FOR "WORKFLOW" SCOPE? GH AUTH REFRESH -H GITHUB.COM -S WORKFLOW

CHAPTER 7 · 12:40 – 12:50 · 1 REQUEST

Agent skills: package know-how once

.github/skills/add-quiz-questions/SKILL.md

```
---
name: add-quiz-questions
description: Add new quiz questions.
---
1. Match the existing object shape.
2. Exactly 4 options, valid answer.
3. Update the start-screen count.
4. Run npm test and fix failures.
```

THEN JUST ASK

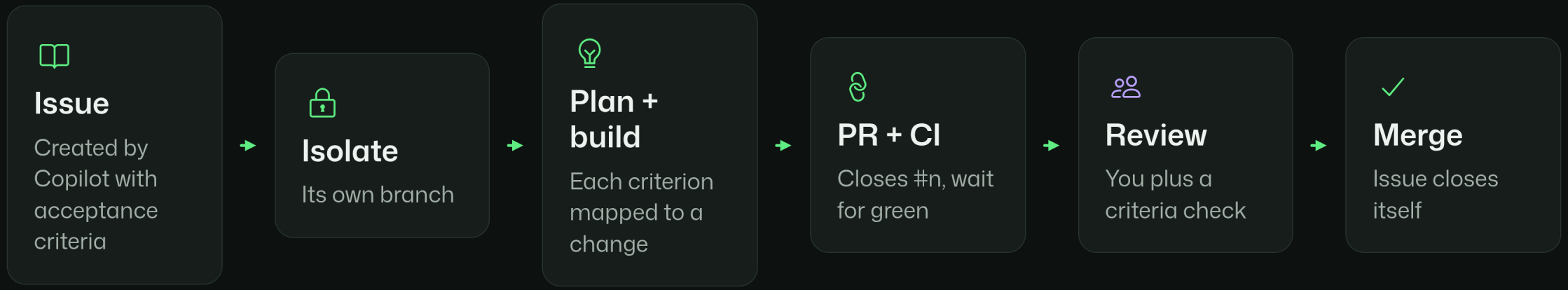
"Add 3 quiz questions about GitHub Actions."

No rules repeated. The same file works in VS Code, the CLI and the app.

SKILL NOT PICKED UP? START A NEW SESSION · FOLDER NAME MUST MATCH NAME:

CHAPTERS 8–9 · 12:50 – 13:25 · 4 REQUESTS

From issue to merged pull request



Issues: GitHub MCP tools in Agent mode

Branch: GitHub view → Start Working on Issue

PR: Source Control → Create Pull Request

BEFORE YOU BUILD: CHECK THE STATUS BAR SHOWS YOUR NEW BRANCH

CHAPTER 9 · REVIEW

Reviewing on Copilot Free

Human review

Read every file in Files changed. Leave at least one review comment.

Criteria check

```
"Compare the PR with the issue's acceptance criteria. Met / not met, with evidence. Flag anything extra. Don't change code."
```

Copilot code review on pull requests needs a paid plan. This pairing catches most of what it would, and teaches you why.

FIX GAPS BY HAND · PUSH · CI RE-RUNS · MERGE WHEN GREEN

CHAPTER 10 · 13:25 – 13:30 · 0 REQUESTS

Ship it, then look back

SETTINGS → PAGES → DEPLOY FROM A BRANCH → MAIN / (ROOT)

your-username.github.io/copilot-dev-days-workshop

? Where did Plan mode change the outcome?

? When was Copilot wrong, and what caught it?

CHECK YOUR USAGE · STOP YOUR CODESPACE · SHARE YOUR LINK

RECAP

Which tool, when

Use…	When…
Completions · next edit suggestions	You know what to write, or you're rippling an edit
Instructions (repo + path)	You keep repeating the same guidance
Plan mode	The work is ambiguous, cross-cutting or costly to undo
Agent mode	You can describe "done" and will review the diff
Agent skills	Your team repeats a task with the same rules
Issues, PRs, worktrees	Independent work that should run in parallel
Tests + CI	Always. They catch what reviews miss

FINISHED EARLY?

Four bonus chapters in every guide

B1 · 1–2 REQUESTS

Accessibility and security audit

B2 · 1 REQUEST

A custom reviewer agent

B3 · 2 REQUESTS

A second issue, in parallel

B4 · 1 REQUEST

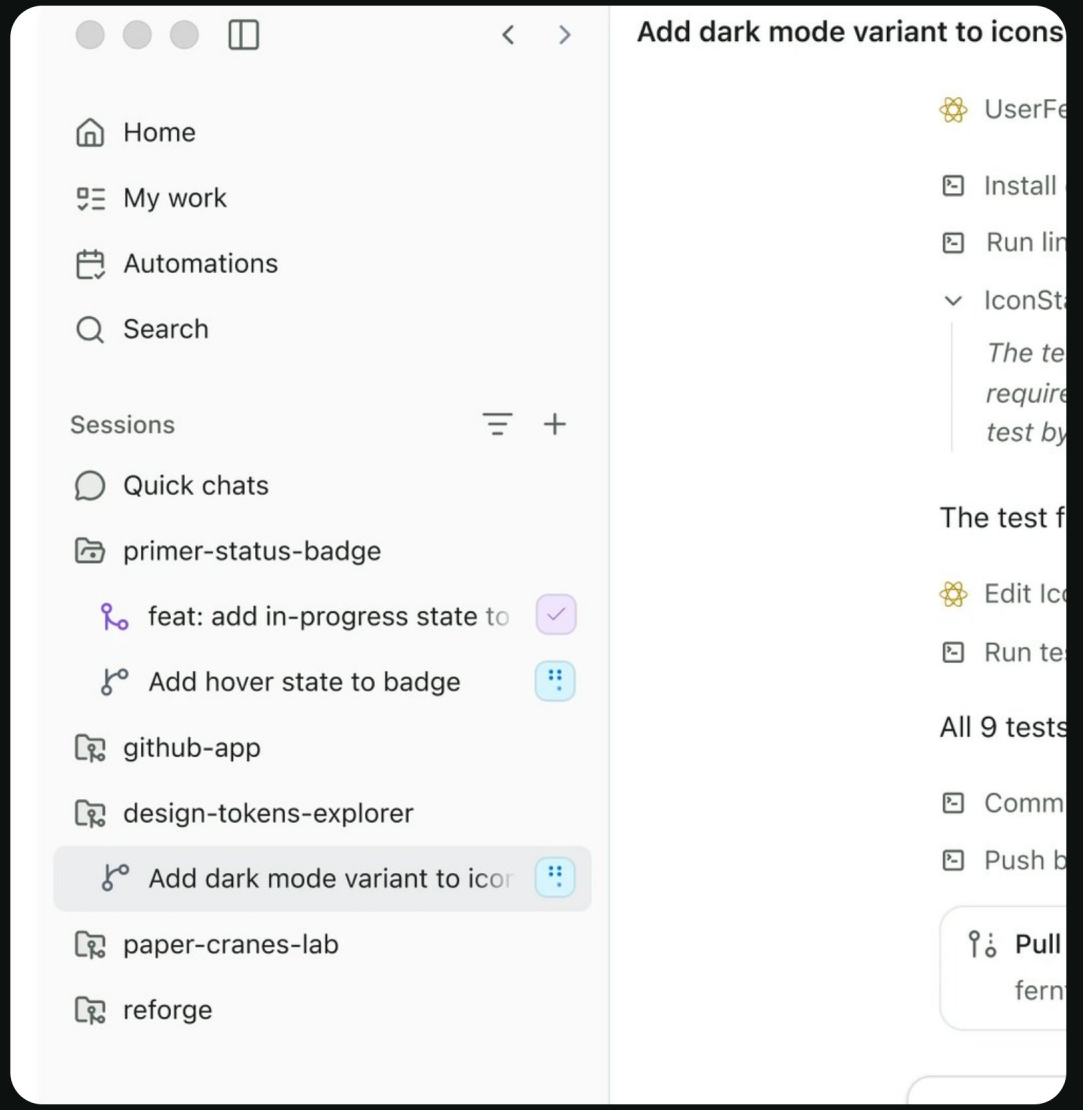
Reusable prompt files

EACH IS INDEPENDENT · WATCH YOUR REMAINING REQUESTS

WORKSHOP

[github.com/your-username/copilot-dev-days-workshop]

Use this template → open workshops/vscode.md → Chapter 0.



gh.io/dev-days/feedback



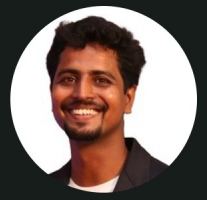
As a Dev Days attendee, you're eligible for **10% off** an in-person pass to **GitHub Universe 2026** in San Francisco on October 28-29.

Use discount code **UNIV26DVDY** at registration.



YOUR SPEAKERS

Connect with us on LinkedIn



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நன்றி!

Thank you!